

THE CLAIM

The format matters more than the word count

AI engines lift two shapes of content: articles between 500 and 2,000 words, and posts between 50 and 299 words.

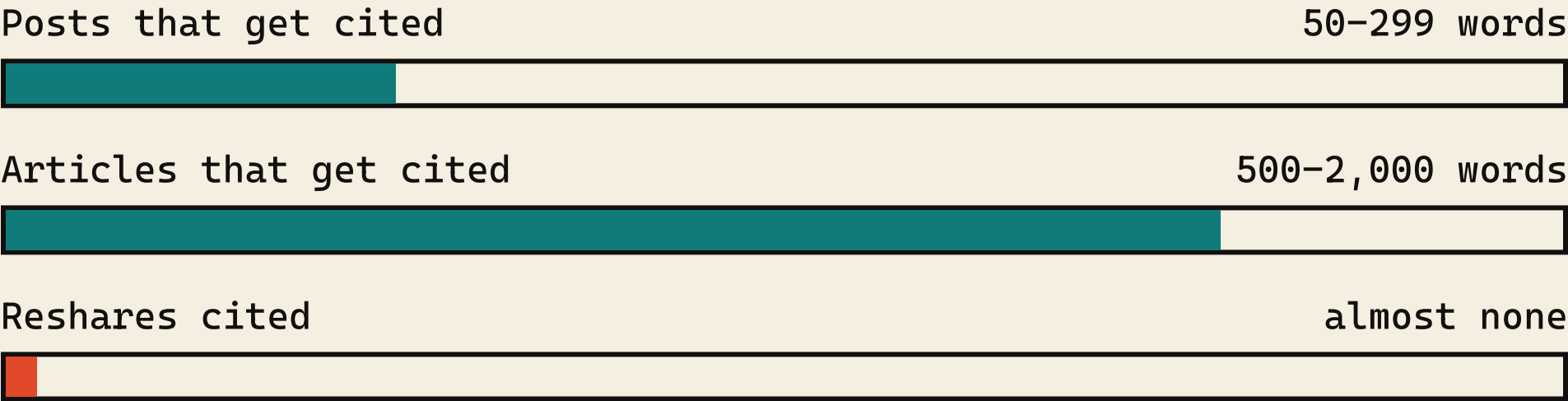
CITED ARTICLES	500 – 2,000 words
CITED POSTS	50 – 299 words
CONTENT THAT IS KNOWLEDGE OR ADVICE	54 – 64%

Semrush, 89,000 cited LinkedIn URLs across 325,000 prompts, March 2026.

02 / WHERE EFFORTS GO WRONG

You are writing the middle:
too long for a post, too thin
for an **article**

The most common content length sits outside both windows, which is why effort and citations stopped tracking together.



Semrush, 89,000 cited URLs, March 2026.

03 / THE PROOF

54-64%

of cited content is knowledge
or practical advice rather
than promotion.

KNOWLEDGE AND PRACTICAL ADVICE	54 – 64%
CITED ARTICLE LENGTH	500 – 2,000 words
CITED POST LENGTH	50 – 299 words
RESHARES CITED	almost none

Semrush, 89,000 cited LinkedIn URLs and 325,000 prompts, January to February 2026.

04 / HOW A PASSAGE GETS LIFTED

The engine quotes a **passage** not a page.

STEP 01

A question is asked somewhere upstream

STEP 02

The engine matches it to a passage it already holds

STEP 03

That passage is quoted with attribution

CITED AUTHORS POSTING FIVE OR MORE TIMES IN FOUR WEEKS

about
75%

Semrush, March 2026. Repetition on one subject is what makes a passage findable.

Reshares are
worthless here.

Almost
none

citation value in the reshares
that AI engines lifted.

RESHARES CITED	almost never
REACTIONS ON MOST-CITED POSTS	15 – 25
MOST-CITED POST AUTHOR TYPE	individual creators

Semrush, March 2026. Virality and citations are measuring two different things.

06 / WHAT TO DO



Write in the two windows and **stop** reshaping the same idea.

01 Post inside the 50 to 299 word window

This is the cited post range. Longer is not better here, it is simply less quotable.

02 Publish long form at 500 to 2,000 words

The article window engines lift instead of posts. Two formats, two separate jobs.

03 Cut the reshare habit

Reshares carry almost no citation value. Original sentences do.

Sources: Semrush, 89,000 cited URLs, March 2026; AuthoredUp, 3M posts, 2026.

THE TAKEAWAY

Take your last post and
count the **words**

If it is over 299 and under
500, you have found the gap.
Split it into a post and an
article.

STEP ONE

count the words

STEP TWO

keep one idea per piece

FOLLOW

for the format tests

Source: Semrush, 89,000 cited LinkedIn URLs, March 2026.